POP Creations / Spruce Line
Licensing Approval Procedure
Document: LIC-PROC-004 Revision: 3 Effective: 2025-11-03
Owner: Licensing Department

1. Purpose
This procedure governs artwork and concept approval for licensed properties. No purchase order for a licensed SKU may be released until licensor sign-off has been recorded.

2. Scope
All new licensed programs, seasonal extensions and reorder SKUs with artwork changes. Applies to Design, Licensing, Merchandising and Product Development.

3. Roles
- Design Lead: prepares the concept package and artwork files.
- Licensing Manager: reviews packages, submits to the licensor, records sign-off in the Artwork Log.
- Buyer: creates purchase orders after sign-off is recorded.
- QA: verifies artwork against the licensor style guide on request.

4. Procedure

4.1 Design submits the concept package (concept form, artwork PDFs, SKU list) to the Licensing queue.

4.2 The Licensing Manager reviews the package for compliance with the licensor style guide within 2 business days.

4.3 The Licensing Manager submits the package to the licensor for sign-off through the Licensing Portal.

4.4 On licensor approval the Licensing Manager records the sign-off in the Artwork Log (column "Licensor sign-off date").

4.5 Design releases the artwork to QA and to the buyer.

4.6 The Buyer may create the purchase order only after the Artwork Log shows the sign-off date.

5. Service standard

Licensor sign-off is expected within 5 business days of submission. The Licensing Manager escalates to the licensor account manager on day 6. Packages returned by the licensor must be corrected and resubmitted within 2 business days.

6. Exceptions

6.1 Reorder SKUs below 5,000 units with unchanged artwork may proceed on the prior sign-off, except when the licensor has issued a style-guide update since that approval.

6.2 Rush programs: the VP of Product may authorise provisional artwork release, but purchase-order release still requires recorded licensor sign-off.

6.3 When the Licensing Manager is out of office, the Backup Licensing Coordinator may record sign-off, but only after the licensor email is filed in the shared mailbox.

7. Revision history

Rev 3 - 2025-11-03 - Added backup coordinator rule (6.3)

Rev 2 - 2025-06-12 - Added service standard in section 5

Rev 1 - 2024-09-01 - First release